

TRAVEL ITINERARY

PUNTA CANA

Dominican Republic

May 30 -- June 6, 2026

Departing Toronto | 8 Days / 7 Nights | All-Inclusive

Beaches

Food

Culture

Adventure

Nightlife

Sun. Sea. Culture. Adventure.

Prepared for Matt Okewusi | Toronto, Canada to Punta Cana, DR

Strongafter35afrimen | Live Well, Travel Well

TRIP AT A GLANCE

DESTINATION	Punta Cana, La Altagracia Province, Dominican Republic
DEPARTURE	Toronto Pearson International (YYZ) to Punta Cana (PUJ)
OUTBOUND	May 30, 2026 (approx. 4.5 hr direct flight)
RETURN	June 6, 2026 (depart PUJ, arrive YYZ same day)
DURATION	8 days / 7 nights -- All-Inclusive
CURRENCY	Dominican Peso (DOP) -- USD widely accepted for excursions and tips
LANGUAGE	Spanish (English spoken in all tourist zones)
TIME ZONE	AST, UTC-4 (1 hr ahead of Toronto in summer)
CLIMATE	High 30-32 C, Low 23-25 C -- warm Caribbean breezes
VISAS	Canadian passport: Tourist e-ticket card (~USD 10), no visa required

GETTING AROUND

- Airport transfers: Pre-book hotel shuttle -- approx. USD 25-35 each way.
- Within resort zone: Taxis and golf buggies. Always agree price before getting in.
- Excursions: Book through hotel concierge or Outback Adventures / Bavaro Adventures.
- Local trips (Macao Beach, Bayahibe): Short taxi -- negotiate fare upfront (~USD 10-20).

TIPPING GUIDE

- Resort staff (bartenders, housekeeping, servers): USD 1-2 per round / USD 2-3 per day.
- Tour guide on day excursions: USD 5-10 per person.
- Taxi / driver: Round up or add USD 2-3 for good service.
- Carry USD 1 and USD 5 bills -- makes tipping smooth all week.

DAY-BY-DAY ITINERARY

DAY 1 -- SATURDAY | May 30, 2026 -- Arrival and First Sunset

Morning -- Departure from Toronto

- Arrive at Toronto Pearson (YYZ) 3 hrs before departure for international check-in.
- Air Canada or WestJet fly direct to Punta Cana (PUJ). Flight: approx. 4 hrs 30 mins.

Afternoon -- Arrival and Check-In

- Clear customs at PUJ. Pay tourist card at airport if not purchased online (~USD 10).
- Transfer to resort. Check in, change, and walk straight to the beach.

Evening

- Dinner at resort. Try whatever looks most local on the buffet.
- Sunset cocktail on the beach -- Presidente beer or a classic Pina Colada.

DAY 2 -- SUNDAY | May 31, 2026 -- Beach Day and Town Exploration

Morning -- Bavaro Beach

- Breakfast at resort, then spend the morning on Bavaro Beach -- a world top-10 beach.
- Water activities: parasailing, jet skiing, and paddleboarding available from the beach.

Afternoon -- Bavaro Town

- Walk or taxi into Bavaro town. Browse stalls -- Larimar jewellery, cigars, crafts.
- Try a street chimichurri (Dominican beef burger with curtido slaw) from a local spot.

Evening

- Jellyfish Beach Restaurant and Bar -- tables on the sand, great cocktails, good food.
- Watch the sunset with a Mamajuana cocktail in hand.

DAY 3 -- MONDAY | June 1, 2026 -- Isla Saona Full-Day Excursion

Full Day -- Isla Saona Island

- Depart resort 8:00 AM. Join a group catamaran excursion (book 1 day ahead).
- Speedboat to Isla Saona -- a UNESCO Biosphere Reserve.
- Stop at the natural swimming pool -- a shallow sandbar scattered with starfish.
- Arrive on Saona: white sand, palm trees, crystal-clear water. The postcard beach of the DR.
- Lunch on the beach: grilled fish, lobster, rice and beans -- included on most tours.
- Return by catamaran -- open bar, live music, dancing on deck (~3-4 hrs back).

Top Operators

- Outback Adventures Punta Cana -- bilingual guides, highly rated.
- Fun Cat Catamaran -- lively, popular with the 35+ crowd.

DAY 4 -- TUESDAY | June 2, 2026 -- Culture Day -- Altos de Chavon

Morning -- Rest

- Slow morning -- swim, spa, or lounge at the resort pool.

Afternoon -- Altos de Chavon, La Romana

- 2-hr transfer west to La Romana. Visit Altos de Chavon -- a recreated 16th-century village.
- Walk cobblestone streets. Church of St. Stanislaus and the 5,000-seat open-air amphitheatre.
- Regional Museum of Archaeology -- Taino artefacts and Dominican indigenous history.
- Browse artisan galleries: leather goods, paintings, ceramics.

Evening

- El Pulpo Cojo (Bavaro) -- local institution for grilled octopus and fresh fish.

DAY 5 -- WEDNESDAY | June 3, 2026 -- Adventure Day

Morning -- ATV and Zipline

- ATV jungle adventure: sugar cane fields, rivers, and local villages (~4 hrs).
- Punta Cana Adventure Park or Bavaro Adventure Park -- ATV from USD 70/person.
- Combo packages: ATV + zipline + buggy ride. Book as a morning block.

Afternoon -- Hoyo Azul, Blue Hole

- Hoyo Azul at Scape Park, Cap Cana -- a natural cenote with vivid blue water.
- Entry ~USD 109: includes beach club, zip-line, cave walk, and cenote swim.
- 40-metre-deep sinkhole. Cool, clear water. One of the Caribbean's iconic spots.

Evening

- Onno's Bar and Grill (Bavaro strip) -- lively, open-air, good food.
- Try the Mamajuana: rum, red wine, honey, and tree bark. Strong. Very DR.

DAY 6 -- THURSDAY | June 4, 2026 -- Golf, Local Beach and Nightlife

Morning -- Golf (Optional)

- Corales Golf Club (Cap Cana) -- ranked #1 in the Caribbean. Oceanside holes. Book ahead.
- La Cana Golf Club -- 27 holes, ocean views. Cocotal Golf -- best value, relaxed pace.
- Non-golfers: mangrove kayak tour along the Yauya river or a lazy resort morning.

Afternoon -- Dominicus Beach

- 45-min drive south to Dominicus/Bayahibe -- quieter, less commercial, more local.
- Snorkelling straight off the beach. Lunch at Pescador Restaurante: fresh fish with tostones.

Evening -- Nightlife

- Coco Bongo Punta Cana -- Vegas-style show plus club. Book tickets early (~USD 75+).
- Imagine Disco -- inside a real limestone cave. Mangu Night Club for bachata until dawn.

DAY 7 -- FRIDAY | June 5, 2026 -- Snorkeling and Last Night Out

Morning -- Catamaran Snorkeling Tour

- Half-day catamaran tour -- departs Bavaro beach 8:30 AM. Open bar included.
- Snorkel reef gardens: tropical fish and sea turtles. Back by 1:00 PM.

Afternoon -- Shopping

- Palma Real Shopping Village -- upscale mall, duty-free. San Juan Shopping Centre for deals.
- Buy: Brugal or Barcelo rum, Mamajuana kits, handmade cigars, Larimar jewellery.

Evening -- Last Night Dinner

- La Palapa Beach Club (Bavaro) -- tables on sand, fresh seafood and steaks.
- Or splurge at Bana Restaurant, Tortuga Bay -- the most upscale dining in Punta Cana.

DAY 8 -- SATURDAY | June 6, 2026 -- Departure Day

Morning

- Set the alarm for 5:30 AM. One last sunrise on the beach. Worth every minute.
- Breakfast at resort. Check out 11:00 AM -- ask for late checkout if flight allows.

Afternoon -- Airport

- Allow 1.5-2 hrs before flight. PUJ duty-free has good rum and cigar prices -- last chance.
- Return flight to Toronto Pearson -- arrive home same evening.
- You land back in Toronto with a tan, a full reset, and a clear head. Welcome back, brother.

FOOD GUIDE -- WHERE TO EAT OUTSIDE THE RESORT

MUST-TRY DOMINICAN DISHES

La Bandera	Rice, black beans, stewed chicken -- the national plate, eaten for lunch.
Sancocho	7-meat stew with root vegetables. Rich, hearty, deeply local.
Mangu	Mashed plantains topped with sauteed onions. Classic DR breakfast.
Tostones	Twice-fried green plantain slices. Goes with everything. Addictive.
Pescado al Coco	Fresh fish cooked in coconut milk. A Caribbean coastal staple.
Chivo Guisado	Braised goat stew. Slow-cooked, fragrant, deeply flavourful.
Chimichurri (DR)	Dominican beef burger in soft bread with curtido slaw. Not the sauce.
Morir Sonando	"To die dreaming" -- orange juice and evaporated milk, chilled.
Presidente Beer	The local beer. Ice cold. Pairs with everything in Punta Cana.
Mamajuana	DR national drink: rum, red wine, honey, and herbs. Try it once.

TOP RESTAURANTS TO VISIT

La Yola Cap Cana Marina	Floating restaurant. Best octopus and lobster in Punta Cana. Reserve ahead.
Jellyfish Restaurant Bavaro Beach	Tables on the sand. Great for sunset. Grills, pasta, and fresh seafood.
El Pulpo Cojo Bavaro	"The lame octopus." Local institution. Casual, cheap, very good.
La Palapa Beach Club Bavaro	Palm-shaded terrace on the beach. Go for fresh fish at lunch or dinner.
Bana Restaurant Tortuga Bay Hotel	Most upscale dining in Punta Cana. Oscar de la Renta-designed hotel.
Ristorante Pomodoro Bavaro	Busy and lively. Lobster pasta is the local favourite.
Pescador Restaurante Bayahibe	45 min south -- freshest fish cooked to order on Bayahibe beach.
Buen Sabor Bavaro Town	Hole-in-the-wall: La Bandera, tostones, and cold Presidente.

ATTRACTIONS, ACTIVITIES AND NIGHTLIFE

TOP ATTRACTIONS

Isla Saona Nature	UNESCO Biosphere Reserve. Natural pool, starfish, pristine beach. The #1 excursion.
Hoyo Azul (Blue Hole) Adventure	40-metre natural cenote in Scape Park. Vivid blue water in a limestone cliff.
Bavaro Beach Beach	World top-10 beach. 30 km of white sand and turquoise water at your doorstep.
Altos de Chavon Culture	Recreated 16th-century village. Cobblestone streets, amphitheatre, Taino museum.
Indigenous Eyes Park Eco	12 freshwater lagoons in jungle. Native wildlife and iguana trails. Puntacana Resort.
Cap Cana Marina Sport	Deep-sea fishing, yachts, La Yola restaurant, and boutique shopping.
Cueva Fun Fun Cave/Hike	Jungle hike, then abseil into a cave with underground pools. Taino rock art inside.
Macao Beach Beach/Surf	Wilder, less developed beach 20 min from Bavaro. Best kitesurfing in the DR.
Corales Golf Club Sport	PGA Tour host course. Caribbean's finest. Ocean-view holes. Book weeks ahead.
Bavaro Lagoon Nature	Mangrove kayak tours. Quiet, off-resort experience. Best at sunrise or sunset.

NIGHTLIFE AND ENTERTAINMENT

- Coco Bongo Punta Cana -- Vegas-style acrobat show plus club. Go Wed or Fri. Book early (~USD 75+).
- Imagine Disco -- inside a real limestone cave. Packed on weekends. A unique experience.
- Mangu Night Club (Bavaro) -- large venue, local crowd, merengue and bachata until dawn.
- Onno's Bar and Grill -- open-air bar on the strip. Good for pre-club drinks and people watching.
- Hard Rock Hotel Casino -- full casino, live bands, and cigar lounge for a relaxed evening out.

WATER SPORTS AND ADVENTURES

- Scuba diving: Dressel Divers (Bavaro) -- PADI certified, reef dives from USD 65.
- Deep-sea fishing: Cap Cana Marina -- marlin, wahoo, mahi-mahi. Charters from USD 450/boat.
- Kitesurfing: Macao Beach -- one of the Caribbean's best kite spots. Lessons available.
- Parasailing: Daily from Bavaro beach. Great aerial views of the coastline.
- Catamaran snorkeling: Half-day tours with open bar. Sea turtles and reef fish. Daily departures.

TRIP SUMMARY

Your Punta Cana Adventure Awaits

- * Day 1 -- Arrive and settle in. First sunset on Bavaro Beach.
 - * Day 2 -- Beach day, Bavaro town, Jellyfish Restaurant.
 - * Day 3 -- Isla Saona full-day catamaran excursion.
 - * Day 4 -- Culture trip to Altos de Chavon, La Romana.
 - * Day 5 -- ATV adventure and Hoyo Azul Blue Hole cenote.
 - * Day 6 -- Golf, Dominicus Beach, Coco Bongo nightlife.
 - * Day 7 -- Catamaran snorkeling, shopping, last dinner out.
 - * Day 8 -- Sunrise on the beach, airport, home to Toronto.
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"Travel is the only thing you buy that makes you richer."

Safe travels, Brother. Strongafter35afrimen